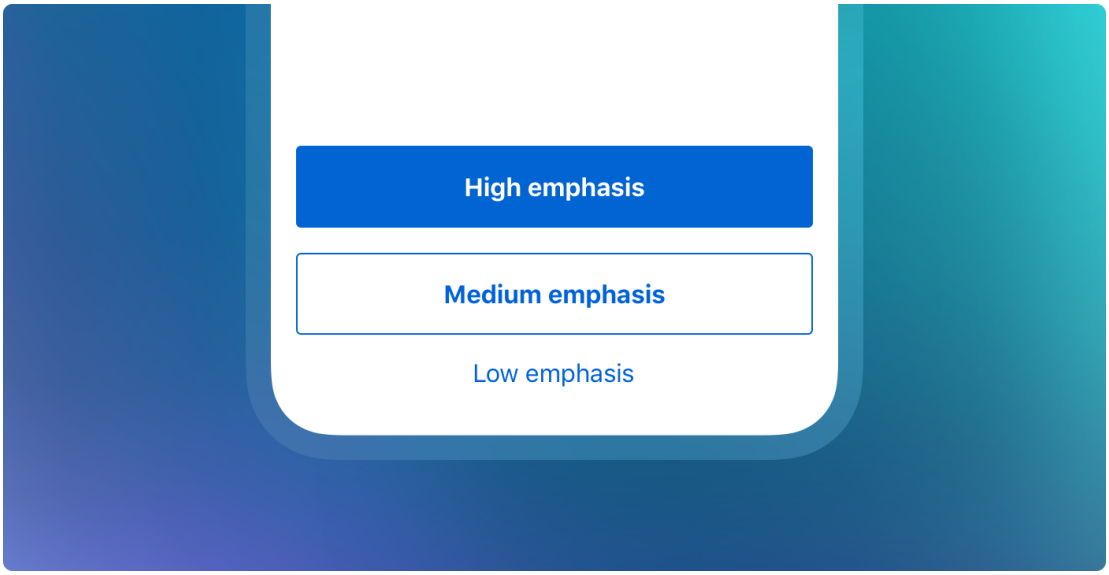
Action Button

Created by Genevieve Lake, last modified by Genevieve Wang on 05 Mar 2021



Version

3

Availability

Web

Android

iOS

On This Page

- Rationale
- Usage Guid
- Emphasis H
- Identify Your
- Variants
- Best Practic
- Supported S
- Interactions
- Accessibility
- Anatomy
- Writing Labe
- Capabilities
- Related Patt

Action buttons are used as a cue to perform actions or navigate within a flow, user can interact by clicking or single-tapping on the button. The visual appearance of a button contains a label describing the action, optional icon and there are 4 variants to choose from depending on its context and action type.

Useful Docs

- Understand Normal vs Destructive Actions
- Adding Supporting Icons
- Why We Don't Support Disabled Buttons
- Interaction for Buttons
- Button Visual Hierarchy

Specs

- Action Button (Web)
- Action Button (Android)
- Action Button (iOS)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground
- Android Catalogue app
- iOS Catalogue app

Rationale

- Naming Action Button Variants
  Deep dive into how we came up with the names for our action buttons.
- Button Visual Hierarchy
  See how we design the button visual hierarchy, and how we evaluated the effectiveness of button styles.
- Removing arrows from Action Buttons on native platforms
  See the analysis on why we discontinued the button styles with arrows in Android and iOS.
- Preventing User Errors
  Using the appropriate button style can help users to make better decisions and prevent them from making unintentional errors.

Usage Guidelines

Use Action Button to:

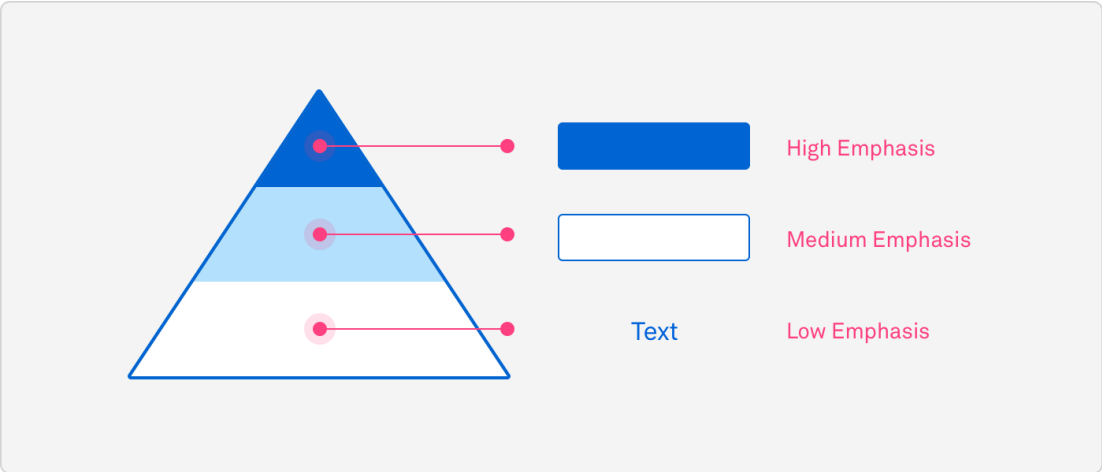
- Persuade the user to perform an important action on the page.
- Allow users to save, edit, add or delete and submitting a form.
- Open a modal dialogue.
- Take the user to the next step in a flow.

Keep in mind that an inline link is not considered as an action button. Learn more on the differences between Action Button and Inline Link.

When implementing Action Button:

When it comes to button implementation on the web, it can be a grey area around the topic of button vs links. For web, our action buttons can be implemented as links `<a>` or as buttons `<button>`. We provide the flexibility so users can make the most semantic markup possible which avoids accessibility issues.

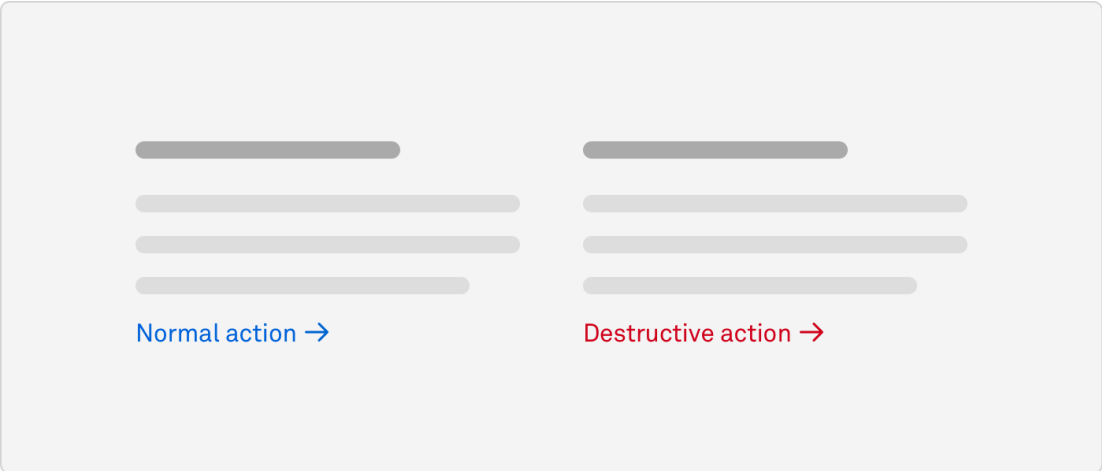
Emphasis Hierarchy



Our action buttons are designed with 3 different level of emphasis (High, medium, low) that attracts different level of attention from the user. They're also designed to provide a clear visual hierarchy within a page.

For recommendation on which button variant to choose for your context, see Action Button Variants.

Identify Your Action Type



To help users to make decisions in their journey, it's important not to use an interactive blue colour to perform a destructive action.

Using the destructive red colour for destructive action not only provides a strong visual cue for warning, but it can also help warn users they are about to commit an action that may result loss of data.

For more guidance on which action is considered destructive, see Understanding Normal & Destructive Actions.

Variants

There are 4 variants available.

For buttons performing normal actions:

- High Emphasis
- Medium Emphasis
- Low Emphasis

For buttons performing destructive actions:

- Destructive

High Emphasis Button

Medium Emphasis Button

High emphasis

`ActionButtonHighEmphasis`

Use this style to **persuade** the user to **perform a desired action** in decision making.

Design recommendation:

- Use it to highlight the strongest call to action on a screen/page.
- Use only one per screen/section to avoid overwhelming the user.
- It can be accompanied by Medium Emphasis or Low Emphasis buttons to balance action hierarchy.

Medium emphasis

`ActionButtonMediumEmphasis`

Use this style if you **don't want attract user to a specific action**, but also don't want to be hidden from user.

Design recommendation:

- It can be paired with High Emphasis or Low Emphasis buttons to balance action hierarchy.
- It can be used to create a neutral emphasis between 2 actions.

Low Emphasis Button

Web

Low emphasis →

`ActionButtonLowEmphasis`

Low emphasis big →

`ActionButtonLowEmphasisBig`

Android / iOS

Low emphasis

`ActionButtonLowEmphasis`

Use this style for **less important actions**, it should never take the role of a primary action on the page.

You can also add a leading icon to help communicate the button's action quickly and reduce ambiguity.

Design recommendation:

- Keep in mind that this style may not have enough affordance as it is designed intentionally not to draw user's attention.
- Pick a suitable icon to support your button's action, see Key Actions with Supporting Icons.
- It can be paired with High Emphasis or Medium Emphasis buttons to balance action hierarchy.
- Avoid using it within a Card UI on native when the card is set to trigger a separate action.
- Do not using this button in a list view alone.

There are 2 sizes available on Web, chose the suitable size to based on the text styles of your paragraph text.

Paragraph in TextBody style.

Low emphasis →

Paragraph in TextBigBody style.

Low emphasis big →

Destructive Button

Destructive →	Destructive
Web	Native
`ActionButtonLowEmphasis`	

Use this style to prompt users before committing an action that will result **loss of data** or **difficult to recover** from.

You can also add a leading icon to help communicate the button's action quickly and reduce ambiguity.

Design recommendation:

- Always use this style to perform destruction actions. For more guidance, see Understanding Normal & Destructive Actions.
- Pick a suitable icon to support your button's action, see Key Actions with Supporting Icons.
- Don't execute destructive action immediately when user pressed on this button. There's a chance users have pressed it by mistake.
- This button should always follow up prompting the users to confirm the destructive action with a confirmation modal or UI.

Best Practices (For Designers)

- **Identify whether the button's action is Normal or Destructive.**
  Identify the correct action type can help communicate the purpose more effectively. Learn more on how to differentiate Normal and Destructive action.

- **Use icons to support the button's action.**
  Icons in action buttons can help clarify a button's action at a glance. Follow icon's recommended usage listed in our Icon Library. Only use icons in the leading icon position, trailing icon is not customisable in this version.

✅ Do.	❌ Don't.
Edit nickname View settings	Setup direct debit Upgrade plan Contact us

- **Not all icons are suitable to be used in action buttons.**
  Don't use Status icons in action buttons as they're designed to convey an outcome of a particular task, not to support performing an action. Learn more on which icons to use to support your action, see Key Actions with Supporting Icons.

❌ Don't.
Low emphasis button Low emphasis button Low emphasis button Low emphasis button

- **Button label is always required in action buttons, don't use icon standalone without a label.**
  If you are looking for icon-only button, see Icon Button pattern.

- **The icon must be the same colour as the label in action button.**

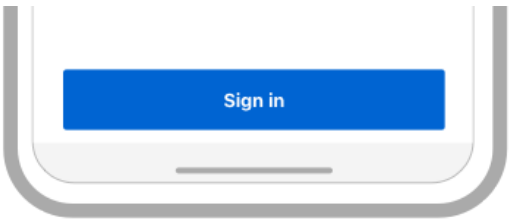
✅ Do.	❌ Don't.

✅ Do.	❌ Don't.
+ Add new service Delete payment	+ Add new service Delete payment

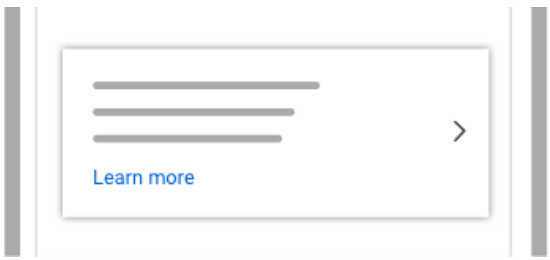
- **Don't use disabled button on Web. Avoid using it on Android / iOS unless it's necessary.**
  On web, disabling buttons prevents them from being accessible from the browser when navigating using the keyboard.
  To understand more details, see our decision on why don't support disabled state.

Best Practices (For Developers)

- **Action buttons should not be underlapped by other UI or content.**
  Buttons placed outside of the platform's recommended area will conflict with system controls and interaction. See Safe Area for iOS, Display cutout for Android and check mobile viewport on devices.

✅ Do.	❌ Don't.
	

- **Make available interactions as clear as possible.**
  Typically a card UI is designed to trigger a separate action (e.g. push or present a new screen), adding more than 1 action inside the card will add more complexity on the UI interactions. Having multiple interactions in one area may confuse the users, it's not clear which tappable area performs what type of actions.

⚠️ Avoid.


For full web development guidance, see Action Button Developer Documentation.

Supported States

Due to the nature of platform behaviour, Web and native platforms have a different number of interaction states. To understand the differences between states, see Interaction States.

States	UI Preview	Web (Visual Preview)	Android (Visual Preview)	iOS (Visual Preview)
Normal		✅	✅	✅
Hover (Web only)		✅	🚫 Not supported	🚫 Not supported
Pressed		✅	✅	✅

States	UI Preview	Web (Visual Preview)	Android (Visual Preview)	iOS (Visual Preview)
Disabled	Disabled	🚫 Not supported	✅	✅
Keyboard Focused ⌨️	Focused	✅	✅	✅
Screen Reader Focused 🎙️	Focused	(System default)	(System default)	(System default)

Interactions

An Action Button can be activated:

- on mouse click (on Web)
- with a single tap (on touch up on Android / iOS)

It can also be activated with keyboard using SPACEBAR or ENTER key on all platforms.

Accessibility Considerations

Action Buttons are designed to meet the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined below. All requirements should be considered and understood when using the pattern. Requirements marked with ⚠️ indicate partial compliance or compliance must be met in build.

General

- 2.5.3 Label in Name (A) - Ensure the buttons label is the same as the accessible name used by assistive technology
  ⚠️ This requirement must be met when in use

Design & Development

- 1.4.1 Use of Color (A) - Colour alone is not used as the only visual cue to convey information. (While this SC is not directly related to buttons, it was still considered in the design)
- 1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum) (AA) - The contrast between the foreground label and the background colour meets minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio.
- 1.4.4 Resize text (AA) - When resized to 200%, the label of the button is not truncated.
- 1.4.10 Reflow (AA) - When scaled to 400%, there is no loss of content or functionality
- 1.4.11 Non Text Contrast (AA) - As all our buttons contain text, this SC is not applicable however it was still reviewed.
- 1.4.12 Text-Spacing (AA) - Text meets minimum the text style requirements.
- 2.1.1 Keyboard (A) - Button element is accessible by keyboard.
- 2.4.3 Focus Order (A) - Buttons receive focus and should be present in a meaningful focus order sequence.
  ⚠️ Partial requirement met - ensure logical order when in use
- 2.4.7 Focus Visible (AA) - Buttons have a visible focus state.
- 2.5.5 Target Size (AAA) - Buttons have a minimum 48x48 touch target in Web/Android/iOS.
- 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A) - Buttons have a name and role can be programmatically determined; The role is implicit if using the native element.

Keyboard

Users must be able to navigate to and select each button using the keyboard alone.

In most browsers, the **TAB** key allows users to navigate between buttons and the **ENTER** or **SPACE** key allows users to select a button.

Screen Reader

A button is announced to screen readers as a button when the native element or component is used. This applies across all platforms; web, iOS and Android.

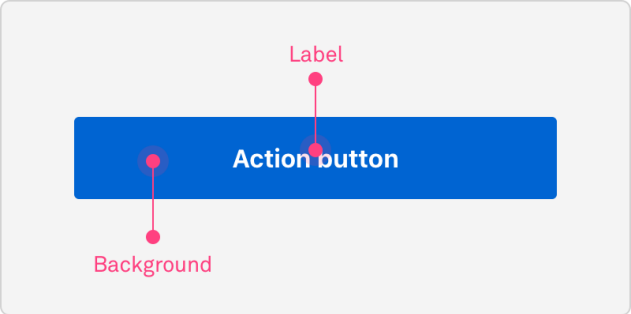
Some screen readers can navigate by buttons by selecting 'form controls' from the elements list or rotor depending on which platform and device you are using.

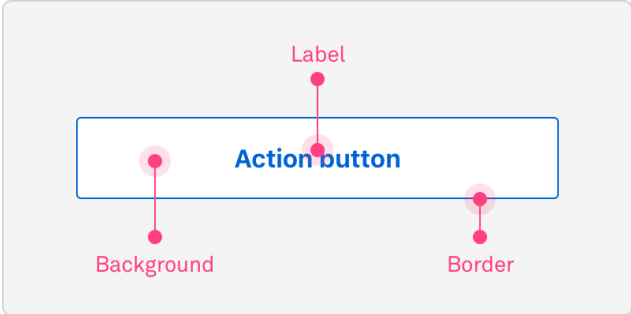
A screen reader will announce the word 'button' together with the accessible name letting the user know that it is a button and what it's purpose is. For example "Button, Search" or "Search, Button" - this can be dependent on platform/screenreader/custom settings by user. For this reason, it's important that the button has an accessible name that describes the purpose of the button.

Anatomy

High Emphasis Button

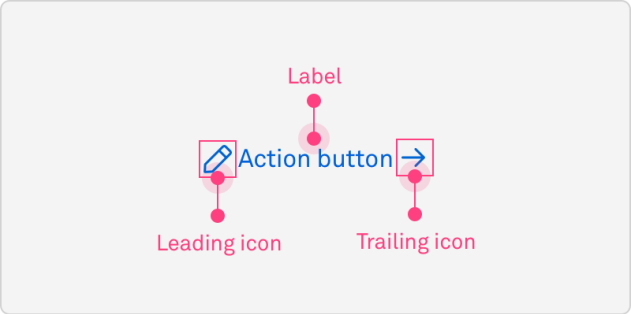
Medium Emphasis Button

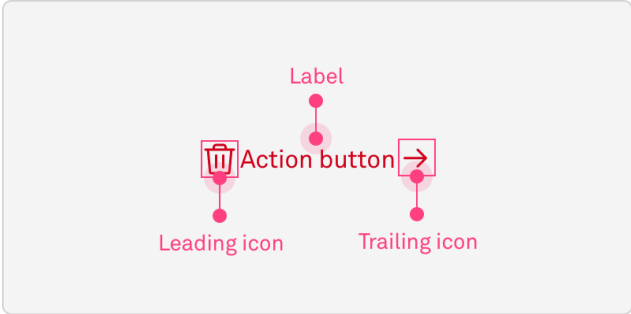




Low Emphasis Button

Destructive Button





Writing Label

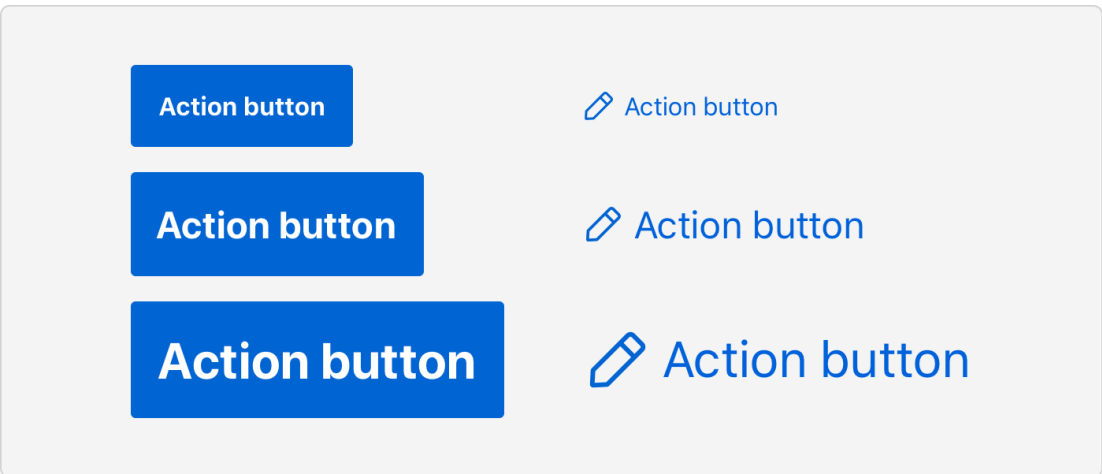
Guidelines to help you write an effective label for action buttons:

- Keep the call to action short and clear. It should only ever be one line in length.
- The label should start with a verb and indicate the action or path the customer will take when tapping or clicking the button.
- Always use sentence case.
- Don't finish with punctuation.
- Don't use the word "button" in the button label or accessibility label.
- Don't use "Yes" or "No" as the label, as it doesn't explain what it does.
- Avoid using unnecessary words, such as "a" or "the".

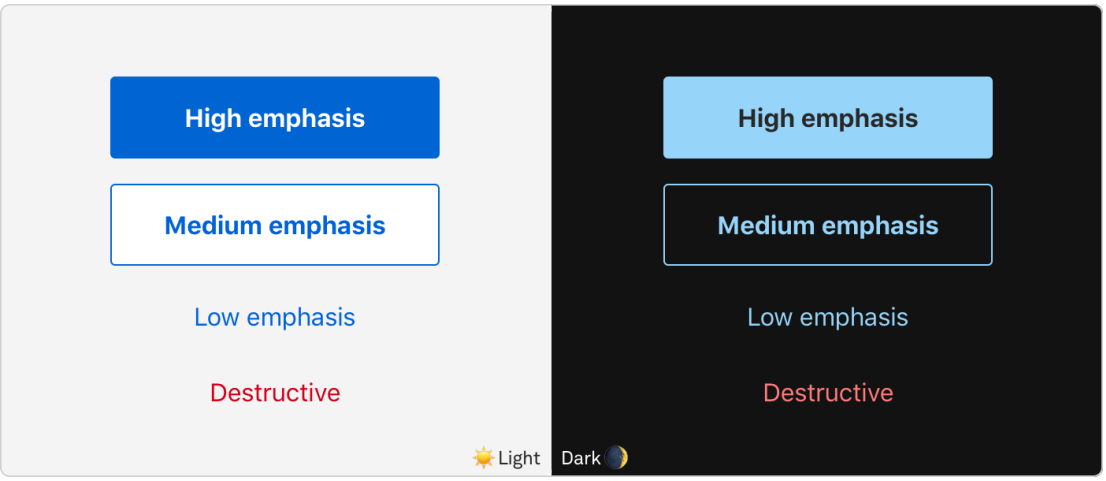
For more information, see actionable language in the Telstra's Content Style Guide.

⚠ The content style guide is currently being constructed by the Content team (by @Scott Collins)

Capabilities



Action Buttons are scaled automatically based on the user's text size preferences.



Action Buttons will automatically update its appearance based on user's light or dark appearance settings.

Related Patterns

- Inline Link
- Icon Button
- Button Group Sequence
- Breadcrumbs
- Action Button Group *(Coming soon)*
- Link List *(Coming soon)*

No labels

Atlassian